

eyecatchers



STUNNING LEAP

Is it a bird or a plane? No, a birdman, Lt Cdr Mahesh Birajdar (below), an expert skydiver, clad in a special winged suit which turns the body into a flying wing, jumped off a helicopter from 11,500-ft and glided like a bird over Kochi's 3-km long Mattancherry channel. "Exhilarating!" is how he described his soaring experience. A veteran with over 1,500 jumps, Birajdar wants to glide across the 16-km distance from India to Sri Lanka. With such stunning skydiving skills, he's indeed flying high.



YASBANT NEGI

SHOW STOPPER

Best remembered for her role as the swimsuit-clad arm candy of Akshay Kumar and John Abraham in *Garam Masala*, **Neetu Chandra** has made her debut as an item girl, grooving to the racy number *Baali Main Sone Waali* in just-released *Summer 2007*. "It's more of a *tamasha* song. I am a dancer and would love to do any song that catches my attention," she says. Well, if only her item number could catch the audience's attention, the film would have set the cash registers ringing at the box-office.



Primetime Saga

It's a family drama all right, but this time Ekta Kapoor's Balaji buddies will fight the epic battle not in her soap operas, but in mythological daily *Kahaani Hamaaray Mahabharata Ki* on 9X. While the other characters had already been finalised, the queen of soaps has zeroed in on her close friend **Anita Hassanandani** to play Draupadi. Having bagged the coveted role, an excited Anita said, "I was shooting for *Fear Factor* in South Africa when Ekta called and I simply accepted the role." When asked who is her favourite out of the five brothers, she replied, "Yudhisthir, for his honesty." The big question: who will step in as big brother, Yudhisthir?

Family Matter

Real life siblings **Delnaaz Paul** and **Bakhtyaar Irani** will compete with each other in reel time in the upcoming reality dance show *Zara Nach Ke Dikha* on Star One. "It's a battle of the sexes on the dance floor," says Paul. The brother and sister duo are in opposite teams and will try and step on each other's toes, though not literally. While Paul has been rehearsing hard to give this show her best shot since "Irani is a better dancer", the actor says his sister "is a better performer". Will it be a family show sans any drama?



Mango or Cream?

Why bother, when you get it together.

